

CROSTINI WITH ARTICHOKE, RICOTTA & PARMESAN

INGREDIENTS

140g artichoke in olive oil, drained
pinch of chilli flakes
small handful mint leaves
zest ½ lemon
1 tbsp olive oil, plus extra for drizzling
2 large or 4 small slices of crusty bread
1 garlic clove sliced
50g parmesan thinly sliced (or
vegetarian alternative)

Ricotta Cheese

300g ricotta cheese
Salt & pepper

INSTRUCTIONS

Step 1: Heat oven to 200C/180C fan. Halve or quarter the artichokes, if whole, and put them in a bowl with the chilli flakes, mint, zest and oil. Season lightly with salt and set aside.

Season your ricotta with salt & pepper and a small splash of olive oil, before creaming together and setting aside.

Step 2: Put the bread on a baking sheet and scatter over the garlic. Drizzle with olive oil and season with sea salt. Bake for 10 mins, or until golden and crisp. Set aside to cool.

Step 3: Fold the pecorino through the marinated artichokes. Now spread a small amount of the ricotta mixture and then spoon over the artichoke mixture and serve.

THE COOKERY

by The Secret Jozi Chef

The Colony Shopping Centre, 345 Jan Smuts Avenue, Craighall, 2024.

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BEEF, CHEESE & HERB SAUSAGE ROLLS

INGREDIENTS

1 small onion , peeled, whole
1/2 cup panko breadcrumbs (Note 1)
500g beef mince, fattier the better
1 egg
2 garlic cloves , minced with garlic press or finely grated
1 beef stock cube , crumbled or 1/2 tsp cooking salt / kosher salt
1/2 tsp salt
1/4 tsp black pepper
1/3 cup finely chopped fresh herbs, parsely, thyme, etc
1 1/2 cups (150g) cheddar , shredded, or other cheese of choice
1/2 cup (50g) parmesan , shredded using box grater
2 sheets frozen puff pastry , butter is better (24cm squares)
1 egg , separated

INSTRUCTIONS

Step 1: Preheat oven 200°C/425°F (180C fan-forced).

Step 2: Onion soak – Grate the onion in a bowl using a box grater, reserving all the onion juices. Add panko breadcrumbs and toss to wet.

Step 3: Then add beef, egg, garlic, stock cube, salt, pepper and herbs. Mix well with hands to combine.

Step 4: Add cheeses, then use fingers to firstly “crumble” the cheese through the beef before mixing well with hands (this method prevents cheese from clumping together).

Step 5: Roll – Barely thaw puff pastry (stiffer = easier to handle). Divide meat into 2 equal logs. Roll up in the puff pastry, then overlap the base with double layer, sealing with egg white. Finish with the seam side down and trim off surplus puff pastry (about 2 cm/0.8”).

Step 6: Cut each log in half. Cut 3 diagonal slashes on the top of each sausage roll. Brush with egg yolk, sprinkle with sesame seeds.

Step 7: Place the sausage rolls on a paper lined tray. Bake for 35 minutes, then transfer onto rack. Bake a further 15 minutes until pastry is deep golden and underside is crispy.

Step 8: Cool on rack 5 minutes before attacking!

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WHIPPED FETA WITH HERBS AND CRISPY PITA CHIPS

For the whipped feta

240gms good quality feta, drained and rinsed
¾ cup Greek yogurt
1 lemon zest
2 tablespoon extra virgin olive oil, more as needed
1 teaspoon Aleppo pepper, or red pepper flakes (to your taste)
2 tablespoons chopped fresh mint
2 tablespoons chopped fresh parsley

For the seed topping:

1 teaspoon toasted sesame seeds
¼ teaspoon chilli flakes
¼ teaspoon lemon zest
2 teaspoon extra virgin olive oil

For the pita chips:

4 pita
2 tsp sumac spice
2 tsp zaatar
1/2 tsp salt
3tsbp olive oil

Instructions

For the whipped feta

Step 1: In the bowl of a large food processor fitted with a blade, combine the feta, Greek yogurt and lemon zest. Blend, and while the processor is running, drizzle olive oil through the top opening, until the feta is whipped to a smooth mixture. Now add your chopped herbs and pulse until combined.

Step 2: Transfer the whipped feta to a serving plate. With the back of your spoon, smooth the top of the feta, making an indentation in the middle (or a "well"). Pour a bit of olive oil all over the feta, then top with your sesame spice topping.

For the spice topping

Step 1: Warm a frying pan over a medium heat, then add your sesame seeds, stir continuously, being careful not to let any burn, until the sesame seeds are fragrant and toasted.

Step 2: Transfer the sesame seeds to a bowl and add the other ingredients, stir to combine and set aside, and use to top your whipped feta.

For the pita chips

Step 1: Warm your pita for 20 seconds in the microwave to help them loosen up, then slice in half through the pita. Now cut the pita into 12 or so chips (as you would a pizza)

Step 2: Add the olive oil, spices and salt to a bowl, stir to combine, then add the pita chips and gently toss them to coat with the seasoning, being careful not to break them.

Step 3: Place the pita chips in a single layer and bake in a hot oven, 220C on the middle wrack, turning once or twice, until golden and crunchy. Keep and eye on them as they can burn easily.

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Pâté de foie de poulet

Ingredients

225gms chicken livers, well-trimmed
1/2 small onion, thinly sliced
1 small garlic clove, smashed and peeled
1 bay leaf
1/4 teaspoon thyme leaves
fine salt
120ml light chicken stock
175gms unsalted butter, at room temperature
2 teaspoons Cognac or Scotch whisky
Freshly ground pepper

Method

Step 1

In a medium saucepan, combine the chicken livers, onion, garlic, bay leaf, thyme and 1/2 teaspoon of salt. Add the stock/water and bring to a simmer.

Step 2:

Cover, reduce the heat to low and cook, stirring occasionally, until the livers are barely pink inside, about 3 minutes. Remove from the heat and let stand, covered, for 5 minutes.

Step 3:

Discard the bay leaf. Using a slotted spoon, transfer the livers, onion and garlic to a food processor; process until coarsely pureed. With the machine on, add the butter, 2 tablespoons at a time, until incorporated.

Step 4:

Add the Cognac, season with salt and pepper and process until completely smooth. Scrape the pâté into 2 or 3 large ramekins. Press a piece of plastic wrap directly onto the surface of the pâté and refrigerate until firm.

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MUSSELS WITH CIDER, LEEKS AND HERBS

INGREDIENTS

2 tablespoons unsalted butter

1 small leek, white and light green parts only, thinly sliced

1 small shallot, thinly sliced

4 medium cloves garlic, thinly sliced

2 bay leaves

Coarse salt and freshly ground black pepper

1 cup hard dry cider or white wine

1kg mussels, cleaned

2 to 3 tablespoons heavy cream

1 tablespoon juice and 1 teaspoon grated zest from 1 lemon

3 tablespoons minced fresh parsley leaves

1 loaf rustic sourdough bread, thickly sliced, drizzled with olive oil, and broiled until heavily toasted

INSTRUCTIONS

Step 1: Melt 1 tablespoon butter in a large saucepan over medium-low heat. Add leeks, shallot, garlic, and bay leave. Season lightly with salt and heavily with black pepper and cook, stirring, until vegetables are very soft but not browned, about 10 minutes.

Step 2: Increase heat to high and add cider or wine. Bring to a boil and let reduce by half, about 2 minutes. Add mussels, stir, cover, and cook, shaking pan constantly and peeking every 30 seconds to stir. As soon as all the mussels are open, transfer mussels to a bowl using tongs. Place pan lid over bowl to keep mussels warm. Remove from heat and whisk in remaining butter along with heavy cream. Return mussels to pot, add parsley, lemon juice, and lemon zest, stir to combine, then transfer to a warm serving bowl. Serve immediately.

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TOMATO & MINT SALAD

INGREDIENTS

400g cherry tomato
1small red onion
handful of mint leaves
1/2 tsp finely chopped thyme leaves
extra-virgin olive oil, for drizzling
a generous pinch of lemon zest

INSTRUCTIONS

Step 1: In a bowl add the chopped tomatoes, torn mint leaves and thyme leaves, the finely chopped onion and a generous pinch of lemon zest. Add the olive oil and then season with salt and pepper, before tossing to coat, set aside. When ready serve on a platter with all the juices to mop up with crusty bread.

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TUSCAN PANZANELLA

INGREDIENTS

4 large red capsicum
4 slices sourdough bread
1/3 cup (80ml) extra virgin olive oil
1 clove garlic, peeled
250g cherry tomatoes, halved
100g pitted kalamata olives, halved
1/2 cup torn basil leaves
1 tablespoon balsamic vinegar*

METHOD

Step 1: Preheat a barbecue or char-grill over medium heat. Cook capsicum, turning, for 10-15 minutes or until skins blacken and blister. Set aside to cool.

Step 2: Brush bread with 1 tablespoon oil, then cook for 30 seconds each side or until lightly charred. Rub bread all over with peeled garlic clove. Tear into bite-sized pieces. Place in a large bowl.

Step 3: Peel capsicum over a bowl to save juice. Discard skins then cut capsicum in half, discarding seeds. Cut capsicum into 3cm pieces and add to bread pieces together with tomatoes, olives and basil. Season to taste with salt and pepper. Toss gently to combine.

Step 4: Whisk remaining oil, vinegar and capsicum juice together. Season to taste, then pour dressing over salad. Toss gently to combine. Serve.

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GRILLED EGGPLANT, TOMATO & MINT SALAD

INGREDIENTS

2 tablespoons extra-virgin olive oil, plus more for drizzling

1 tablespoon fresh lemon juice

2 garlic cloves, grated

½ teaspoon za'atar

½ teaspoon sea salt, plus more for sprinkling

Freshly ground black pepper

1 medium eggplant, 1 pound, cut into ½-inch-thick rounds

1 red bell pepper, stemmed, seeded, and quartered lengthwise

1 cup cherry tomatoes, halved

½ cup crumbled feta cheese

⅓ cup red onions

⅓ cup basil leaves

⅓ cup mint leaves

INSTRUCTIONS

Step 1: In a large bowl, whisk together the olive oil, lemon juice, garlic, za'atar, salt, and pepper. Heat a grill or grill pan to medium-high heat.

Step 2: Place the eggplant and red pepper pieces on a large plate or in a large baking dish and drizzle with olive oil and sprinkle with salt and pepper. Toss to coat.

Step 3: Place the eggplant and pepper on the hot grill and cook for 2 to 5 minutes per side, or until well charred and tender. Remove from the grill and chop into 1-inch pieces.

Step 4: Add the grilled veggies to the bowl with the dressing and stir to coat. Let sit for 5 minutes, then fold in the tomatoes, feta, red onions, and half the basil and mint. Season to taste, garnish with the remaining basil and mint, and serve.

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MEDJOOOL DATE STICKY TOFFEE PUDDING

INGREDIENTS

Syrup Ingredients:

226.8 g medjool dates* , pitted

240 ml boiling water

75g butter , room temperature

145 g light brown sugar , firmly packed

8.5 g vanilla extract

2 large eggs , room temperature

35g molasses

210g all-purpose flour

1 heaped tsp baking powder

1tsp baking soda

Pinch of salt

Toffee Sauce Ingredients:

120ml heavy whipping cream

115g butter

165g light brown sugar , packed

1 Pinch salt

1 tsp vanilla extract

METHOD

1. **Preheat** the oven to 175C. **Lightly grease** a 12-cup muffin tin or **ramekins**.

2. **Add the dates** to the bowl of a **food processor** blender and **pour boiling water** on top. Set aside for **5 minutes**.

3. Meanwhile, prepare the batter: **Cream together butter** and **brown sugar**. **Add eggs**, one at a time, beating after each addition. **Add the molasses** and **vanilla** and mix.

4. **Sift** together the **flour, baking powder** and **salt**, and then **stir into the batter**.

5. **Pulse the date mixture** in a food processor, then stir in **baking soda**. **Pour date mixture into batter** (no need to strain) and fold in gently to combine (**don't over-mix**).

6. Pour batter into prepared pan. **Bake for about 18 – 20** minutes or until toothpick inserted in the center comes out clean or with few crumbs. Don't overbake or cake will be dry.

7. **Serve** muffin cakes flat-side up, **with warm toffee** sauce on top.

1. **Add cream, butter, brown sugar**, and salt to a saucepan. Cook over low heat, **stirring**, until **sugar dissolves** and sauce is smooth, and **slightly thickened about 7-10** minutes. Remove from heat and stir in vanilla.

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FIERY PRAWNS

Ingredients

70g small red chillies
5 garlic cloves, lightly crushed
70ml olive oil
2 tbsp red wine vinegar
2 1/2 tsp tomato puree
2 1/2 tsp caster sugar
1/2 tsp dry chilli powder
1 heaped tbsp sweet paprika
2 tsp fine salt
Pinch dry oregano

STEP 1: Preheat oven to 180. Split chillies lengthways and place them in a small pan or roasting tray, roasting tray with the garlic and olive oil. Roast for 10 minutes or cook over low heat for 10-minutes to not allow the garlic to brown

STEP 2: Leave to cool for a few minutes, then transfer to a food processor. Add the remaining ingredients for the marinade and blend till smooth (if using a mortar and pestle start by crushing the roasted chili and garlic with the salt, before adding the balance of dry spices, alternating with the wet.

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Chimichurri Marinade

Ingredients

30g flat leaf parsley
5 large cloves garlic
1 tsp dry oregano
150ml olive oil
1/2 tsp dry chili flakes
35ml red wine vinegar
1 tsp sea salt
1 tsp freshly ground black pepper

Directions

Step 1:

Bring a small pan of water to the boil and have an ice bath ready. Blanch the parsley for 1 minute, then drain immediately and plunge into icy water. Drain and pat dry

Step 2:

Place all the ingredients into a food processor and pulse. Serve immediately or refrigerate in a sealed container for 3-4 days

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PASSION FRUIT CHEESECAKE BARS

INGREDIENTS

For the crust:

2 cups all-purpose flour

½ cup granulated sugar

½ teaspoon salt

1 cup (2 sticks) butter - chilled and cut into small cubes

For the filling

240gms cream cheese - softened

2 cups granulated sugar

¼ cup flour

¾ cups fresh-squeezed passion fruit juice

⅓ cup powdered sugar - plus more for topping

6 large eggs

1 teaspoon vanilla

METHOD

STEP 1: Preheat oven to 350 degrees and line a 9x13 inch pan with foil or parchment with plenty of overhang around the edges to lift the bars out of the pan before cutting.

STEP 2: Prepare the crust by combining flour, sugar, salt, and butter cubes in a food processor or blender. Cover and pulse until fine crumbs form. (You can also do this with a pastry cutter, fork, or with your fingers in a large bowl.)

STEP 3: Press crust into prepared pan and bake for 10 minutes while you prepare the filling.

STEP 4: Prepare the filling by combining cream cheese and sugar in a large bowl. Cream together until smooth. Mix in flour, powdered sugar, passion fruit juice, eggs, and vanilla until completely incorporated.

Pour filling over crust and return to oven for 30 minutes.

STEP 5: Allow to cool for about 20 minutes, then cover and transfer chill in the fridge 4 hours or overnight. Lift the foil edges to remove the bars from the pan, slice into squares, sprinkle with additional powdered sugar, and serve.

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ROASTED BALSAMIC TOMATO & THYME GALETTE

For the cherry tomato filling

500gms cherry tomatoes
2 tablespoons olive oil
2 tablespoons balsamic vinegar
7-8 cloves garlic adjust to taste
1 tablespoon fresh chopped thyme
¼ teaspoon salt

For the Galette Pastry

1 and ½ cups all purpose flour
½ teaspoon salt
½ cup unsalted butter
5-6 tablespoons ice cold water

For the galette dough

Step 1: Mix together the flour and salt in a large mixing bowl. Using a pastry cutter or your fingers, cut in the cubes of butter until they are crumbly and pea-sized.

Step 2: Mix in the ice-cold water one tablespoon at a time, stirring with a wooden spoon until a cohesive ball of dough forms. The dough will still be slightly crumbly, that's okay. Wrap tightly in plastic wrap and let rest in the fridge for 30 minutes.

Preheat the oven to 220C.

For the cherry tomato filling:

Step 1: Meanwhile, prep the filling. Roughly chop the garlic. Heat the olive oil over medium heat in a large skillet. Add the garlic, cherry tomatoes, balsamic vinegar, thyme, and salt. Saute just until the cherry tomatoes burst, about 8-10 minutes, stirring frequently. Set aside.

To assemble the galette

Step 1: On a lightly floured surface, roll out the pastry dough into a 12-inch circle. Place on a parchment paper lined sheet pan or on a preheated pizza stone.

Step 2: Pour the cherry tomato filling into the center of the galette, leaving about 2 inches of a border. Fold the border in over just the edges of the cherry tomatoes

Step 3: Bake for 25-30 minutes at 220C on the middle oven rack, until the galette is golden brown. Remove the galette from the oven and allow to cool for 10 to 15 minutes before cutting.

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GRILLED NECTARINE & MOZARELLA SALAD

INGREDIENTS

15g unsalted butter
2 tbsp caster sugar
50g whole pecans
3 ripe nectarines, stoned and cut into eighths lengthways
4 tbsp extra virgin olive oil, plus extra for brushing
2 tbsp balsamic vinegar
1 tsp honey
2 x 100g balls of fresh mozzarella
70g rocket
bunch of basil leaves, roughly torn
pinch of chilli flakes

METHOD

STEP 1

Heat the butter and sugar in a small frying pan over a medium heat until the butter has melted. Add the pecans and stir to coat in the buttery sugar. Continue to cook for about 5 mins, stirring until the pecans are crisp and caramelised. Tip out onto a sheet of baking parchment and leave to cool. Once cooled, roughly chop and set aside.

STEP 2

Heat a griddle pan over a high heat and generously brush the nectarine slices with some olive oil. Griddle for 1-2 mins on each side until charred and caramelised. Remove to a serving platter and set aside.

STEP 3

Whisk the 4 tbsp olive oil, vinegar and honey together with some seasoning to make a dressing.

STEP 4

Scatter the rocket and basil across the base of your serving plate, then nestle the charred nectarine before tearing the balls of mozzarella and dotting across the salad. Drizzle over the dressing, scatter with the pecans and sprinkle with a pinch of chilli flakes to serve.

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ZESTY GREEN BEAN SALAD

INGREDIENTS

Water
450gms green beans, trimmed
Salt and pepper, to taste
Crushed red pepper flakes, optional, to taste
100gms quality crumbled feta cheese, to taste
2 tbsp (or more to your liking) pitted olives, chopped
Handful of cherry tomatoes, cut in half

For dressing

2 tbsp extra virgin olive oil
2 tbsp freshly squeezed lemon juice
1 to 2 garlic cloves, minced
2 tbsp chopped fresh dill
1/2 tsp sweet Spanish paprika
Salt and pepper, to taste

INSTRUCTIONS

Step 1: Prepare dressing. In a small bowl, whisk together extra virgin olive oil, lemon juice, garlic, fresh dill, Spanish paprika, pinch of salt and pepper. Set aside for now.

Step 2: Bring a large pot filled with water to a boil. Add green beans. Cook for 5 minutes, then, keep the pot of boiling water going, but using tongs, transfer green beans to an ice bath (a bowl of ice and ice cold water) for 5 minutes. Return beans to boiling water to finish cooking until tender, about 10 more minutes or so. Drain well.

Step 3: Transfer warm beans to a mixing bowl. Add the chopped tomatoes, toss with a little salt and pepper. Give the dressing a quick stir to combine well, then pour over the green beans. Toss again to coat.

Step 4: Transfer to a serving platter. Sprinkle crushed pepper flakes and crumbled feta. Top with chopped olives. Serve at room temperature.

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ALMOND CHERRY CHOCOLATE TRIFLE

INGREDIENTS

710mls whole milk
2 tsp vanilla extract
1 strip lemon peel
6 egg yolks
150gms granulated white sugar
45gms all purpose flour
120 grams dark chocolate, chopped

Bitter Cherries

200gms fresh cherries
2tbsp sugar
90ml Amaretto

Assemble Zuppa Inglese

18 savoiardi cookies or Madeira cake
200ml cream cold - (Optional)
100gms flaked almonds, toasted till lightly golden.

INSTRUCTIONS

Step 1: Place the vanilla, milk, and a strip of lemon rind in a medium sized pot. Heat over low heat until the milk is just before simmering point. Don't boil.

Step 2: In a bowl whisk egg yolks, granulated white sugar and all purpose flour until smooth. Take care that there are no lumps. Remove lemon rind from the milk.

Step 3: Slowly pour the hot milk onto the egg yolk mixture, whisking constantly. Strain the mixture back to the pot and place over medium low heat. Whisk constantly until the mixture comes to a boil and thickens. Simmer for 1 minute to cook the flour.

Step 4: Add the chopped chocolate to the custard and stir until the chocolate has melted and is thoroughly combined. Cover with plastic wrap ensuring the plastic is in complete contact with the chocolate pastry cream

Refrigerate until thoroughly chilled. Before using, stir until smooth.

Assemble Trifle

Step 1: Cut the savoiardi in half and dip quickly but completely into the amaretto cherry mixture, or if using madeira cake slice 1cm thick and line your serving dish, now brush generously with the amaretto cherry mixture.

Step 2: Now top this with half your cherries and their reserved syrup.

Step 3: Top with your chocolate pastry cream followed by a second layer of soaked biscuits or cake, and the balance of your cherries and then top with your whipped cream. Cover with plastic wrap and refrigerate for at least 2 hours to set.

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GRILLED MEDITERRANEAN CHICKEN

INGREDIENTS

1 cup whole-milk Greek yogurt
2 tablespoons freshly squeezed lemon juice, or more to taste
2 tablespoons olive oil
2 tbsp tomato paste
6 cloves garlic, minced
1 tablespoon red pepper flakes
1/2 tablespoon salt
1 teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
1 teaspoon paprika
1200 gms boneless, skinless chicken thighs, halved
4 long metal skewers

METHOD

1. Whisk yogurt, lemon juice, olive oil, tomato paste, garlic, red pepper flakes, salt, black pepper, paprika, and together in a bowl.
2. Place chicken thigh halves into the yogurt marinade and coat them thoroughly on all sides. Cover bowl with plastic wrap and refrigerate 2 to 8 hours.
3. Preheat an outdoor grill for medium-high heat and lightly oil the grate.
Using 2 skewers for each kebab, thread half of the chicken thighs onto each pair of skewers making a fairly thick "log" shape.
4. Place kebabs on grill. Do not try to turn them until they begin to unstick from the grill, 3 or 4 minutes. Turn kebabs and grill the other side 3 or 4 minutes; turn. Continue cooking and turning until chicken is no longer pink in the center and the juices run clear, about 6 minutes.

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RARE ROAST BEEF FILLET WITH A HERB CRUST

Ingredients:

750 g beef fillet
1 tbsp olive oil
1/2 cup coarsely chopped fresh flat leaf parsley
1/4 cup coarsely chopped fresh dill
1/2 cup walnuts, roughly chopped
1 clove garlic, crushed
2 tsp finely grated lemon zest
2 tsp lemon juice
1 tbsp olive oil

Instructions

Step 1

Preheat oven to 220C

Step 2

Rub beef with oil. Now heat a frying pan until hot and then add the beef fillet, sear on all sides until browned all over.

Step 3

Combine the herbs,, lemon zest, lemon juice, olive oil and nuts in a bowl, stir to combine.

Step 4

Transfer beef to oven, roast beef uncovered for 15-minutes. Remove and sprinkle with 3/4 of the herbs

Step 4

Cover with foil and roast a further 15-minutes or until cooked as desired.

Step 5

Remove the beef from the oven, and stand for 10-minutes, now slice the beef finely and serve sprinkled with the remaining herb and nut mixture.

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ROASTED ASPARAGUS WITH A HERB PANGRATTATO

FOR THE ASPARAGUS AND PANGRATTATO

1 kg asparagus washed, dried and wood ends removed if necessary
3 tablespoons unsalted butter, melted
2 tablespoons olive oil
5 cloves garlic, minced
1/2 cup fresh grated Parmesan cheese (or Parmigiano-Reggiano cheese)
1/2 cup Panko breadcrumbs
2 teaspoons parsley, finely chopped
Zest of 1 lemon
Salt and pepper, to taste (about 1/2-3/4 teaspoon salt and 1/4 teaspoon pepper)

Instructions

Step 1: Preheat the oven to 205°C. Lightly grease a baking tray or sheet with non stick cooking oil spray.

Step 2: Place the trimmed asparagus in a bowl. In a second bowl combine the butter, olive oil, 1 large clove minced garlic, parsley and bread crumbs, mix to combine well. If the mixture is too wet add an additional tbsp of bread crumbs.

Step 3: Add the crumb mixture to the asparagus and mix by hands to carefully and evenly coat the asparagus with the oil and crumbs.

Step 4: Transfer the asparagus and breadcrumb mixture onto prepared baking sheet and arrange into one even layer. Bake for about 10 minutes, or until the asparagus are just tender.

Step 5: Grill for 2-3 minutes until breadcrumbs are golden browned and asparagus has reached desired doneness. Serve warm on a warmed platter.

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CLASSIC CAESAR SALAD

For The Croutons

1/2 French Baguette, cut in half and thinly sliced, 0.5cm thick
3 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
1 tsp minced garlic, 2 small cloves
2 Tbsp grated parmesan cheese

Caesar Salad Dressing:

6-8 anchovies
2 garlic cloves
2 pasteurized eggs
Juice of 1 large lemon
1 cup olive oil
1/2 cup grated parmesan cheese
sea salt

For the Caesar Salad:

1 large romaine lettuce, (or 2 small heads romaine)
1/3 cup parmesan cheese, shredded or shaved

Instructions

Step 1: Preheat oven to 190°C. Cut the baguette in half lengthwise through the top of the baguette then slice diagonally into .05cm thick pieces. Place the breads onto a baking sheet.

Step 2: In a small bowl, combine 3 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil and 1 tsp of finely minced garlic. Drizzle the garlic oil over the croutons and sprinkle the top with 2 Tbsp grated parmesan cheese.

Step 3: Toss until evenly coated. Spread in a single layer over the baking sheet and bake at 190°C until light golden and crisp (10-12 minutes), or to desired crispness.

How to Make Caesar Salad Dressing:

Step 1: In the bowl of a small food processor add the anchovies and garlic and pulse 20-30 times until the ingredients are finely chopped.

Step 2: Next, add in the eggs and 1/2 of the lemon juice and process on high for 20 seconds until completely mixed together and smooth.

Step 3: While processing at high speed, slowly drizzle in the oil until it becomes thick and creamy.

Step 4: Finish by adding in the cheese, remaining 1/2 lemon juice, and salt, and process on low speed until combined.

Refrigerate until ready to use.**How to Make Caesar Salad:**

Step 1: Rinse, dry and chop or tear the romaine into bite-sized pieces. Place in a large serving bowl and sprinkle generously with shredded parmesan cheese and cooled croutons. Drizzle with caesar dressing and toss gently until lettuce is evenly coated.

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CRANBERRY ALMOND BABY SPINACH SALAD

INGREDIENTS

1 tablespoon butter
3/4 cup almonds, blanched and slivered
450gms baby spinach, rinsed and torn into bite-size pieces
1 cup dried cranberries
2 tablespoons toasted sesame seeds
1 tablespoon poppy seeds
1/2 cup white sugar
2 teaspoons minced onion
1/4 teaspoon paprika
1/4 cup white wine vinegar
1/4 cup cider vinegar
1/2 cup vegetable oil

METHOD

STEP 1

In a medium saucepan, melt butter over medium heat. Cook and stir almonds in butter until lightly toasted. Remove from heat, and let cool.

STEP 2:

In a medium bowl, whisk together the sesame seeds, poppy seeds, sugar, onion, paprika, white wine vinegar, cider vinegar, and vegetable oil.

STEP 3:

Toss with spinach just before serving.

In a large serving dish, combine the spinach with the toasted almonds and cranberries.

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For The Anchovy Butter:
